

“I never heard that before,” Ben said in amazement. “Let’s put the house up for sale today.”

“Hold it just a minute,” Bryan said. “Don’t do anything in haste. Pray about the decision together first, and if you think it’s the right way to go, ask God to bring the right buyer for your home. Remember, there’s no guarantee a house will sell quickly these days. You need to think about some other areas too. I’m going to give you a workbook that will help you plan each area of your budget. It’s especially important that you allocate money for non-monthly expenses, such as clothes, car maintenance, and annual insurance. Those are normally areas that create crises when they are due.”

“That’s certainly true in our case,” Naomi said.

“We want your budget to be totally realistic, or it will only work a short while. You’re going to be tight on money until some of your past debts are paid. But with some discipline you will be debt-free in a few years.

“I have one additional recommendation for you. I believe Naomi is far better equipped to maintain the records and pay the bills. The short personality test I gave you last time shows that she is a detail person, but you, Ben, are a generalist.”

“Yeah, I’d have to agree,” Ben said, “but I always thought that it is the man’s responsibility to handle the finances in his family.”

“Ben, God gives each of us gifts and abilities to help us in our daily lives. It’s clear that Naomi is better suited to be the bookkeeper in your family. The two of you together need to work out a financial plan, and then she will pay the bills and maintain the records. God doesn’t make mistakes; He provided the necessary talents in Naomi that you lack, and vice versa. I suggest that you read Proverbs 31 together, because it describes a husband and wife working as a team. It’s clear that each uses different and unique abilities to enhance the relationship.

“Our short-term goal will be to get your finances to the point that you’re able to pay everyone what you owe them each month. That will mean Naomi will need to continue to work, at least for a while.